

CASE A-8: This case, occurring in Hillsdale and Dexter, Michigan, 1966, is better remembered in UFO research lore for its cover-up explanation — "Swamp Gas". The alleged UFO landings there had many ramifications: Embarrassment for Dr. J. Allen Hynek, then Air Force consultant, for the mix-up over his references to "swamp gas" at a press conference and Gerald Ford's dissatisfaction with the official explanation and his request for a Congressional inquiry. This, in turn, so say UFO analysts, helped bring into being the Colorado Project (headed by Dr. Condon) which led to the demise of Project Bluebook. Although this case is well known to research, only a few may know some of the behind-scenes operations.

My informant who knew firsthand the behind scenes story of the landed craft in Dexter, and the methods employed in its cover-up is FB, a former law enforcement officer (name withheld on request). Arrangements for me to discuss his first person role, March 12, 1980, were made by James Minton, a pharmacist in Norris City, Illinois.

According to FB, on March 21, 1966, at 6:20 p.m., he and officer "C" on patrol, were first to see the alien craft on the ground of farm property in a clearing of swamp. From a distance of about 150 yards they estimated that the object was about 100 feet in diameter. They also observed that cattle in the area were restless and noisy, some scampering among the herd. FB reported the landing to the Sheriff (name withheld) who put in an urgent call to Selfridge AFB. In quick response, elements of the National Guard and Air Force personnel were rushed to the area, many arriving by helicopter. Some were assigned to control highway traffic, others to prevent a mob of curious people who heard about the UFO from trying to reach the site. The clearing in the swamp was hard to reach by road, said FB, but he knew the area well as he had hunted there — and, yes, he was aware of "fox fire" or "swamp gas".

"What I saw was not fox fire," he emphasized. "This was definitely a large craft, like a pot, with a dull glow and no windows." He added, "A pool of water near it sizzled, causing vapor to rise." Asked about a sound, he said, "Sounded like a turbine, a low whine or hum."

When the Air Force came and took charge, about 7:30 p.m., they ordered all the police at the site to withdraw and stay away. MP's were everywhere, he said, and well armed. Photos were taken by one officer who waded into the marsh for a close-up had his film confiscated. Said FB, Air Force officers, however, took many photographs, including shots from a helicopter.

Nothing was left undone, said FB, where it concerned security. The area was barricaded, or roped off for three weeks and the farmer was ordered to stay away. Maybe because it was contaminated, he said. Where the object landed there was a circle in a soybean plot that was burned. Soils samples were taken. Then the whole area was bulldozed, including the soybean field. Everything was hush-hush, said FB. Police reports, his report and the records in the sheriff's office disappeared. Then, everyone in the force, including he and "C", were transferred to other parts of the county.

The UFO was not disabled, as far as FB knew, although there was a suspicion that it might be and that it could be captured, "But no one got it," he said. "I saw it take off and climb straight up into the sky and disappear."

"Swamp gas doesn't do that," said FB.

COMMENT: No crashed UFO; no retrieval in Dexter. If the craft was disabled to account for its long stay, it was not seriously impaired. This case points out, however, the extenuating security measures taken by the Air Force at a landing or crash site.

CASE A-9: The complexity of the UFO mystery is well illustrated in this report by veteran researcher, Tommy Blann of Lewisville, Texas. His ability to dig deeper, beyond top soil, for facts is self-evident in the following report, dated March 30, 1982, which sheds new light on joint UFO and helicopter activity observed in Texas.

There have been a number of incredible stories surfacing over the years by active military personnel on duty at Fort Hood and by civilians employed at the base or their immediate family members about a huge underground complex built in the side of a small hill in which a camouflaged section of land opens up like "sliding doors" to reveal an entrance to this secret installation.

Over the years, I ran into several individuals who told me bits and pieces about this secret underground complex and others scattered across the U.S., none of them knowing each other nor what the others had related to me. This information, like a lot of information in the possession of individual researchers, was recorded and filed away as confidential for future reference. It wasn't until certain information surfaced about "crashed discs" by Leonard Stringfield and other less

known individuals, plus the recent Cash/Landrum incident investigated by John Schuessler that I felt compelled to release this information publically.

It is my personal opinion that these individuals have told me the truth as they know it, and it would be hard to conceive how a number of individuals could concoct such stories in identical detail unless there is some truth in the basis of their claims. There are also three incidents involving helicopters around low level UFOs, one incident which I personally witnessed, that adds further credence to the claims made in this report.

Located in Central Texas is a large Army military reservation known as Fort Hood which covers approximately 160,000 acres and is surrounded by several small towns such as Copperas Cove, Gatesville, Killeen, Temple and Belton. It was originally named Camp Hood, after John Bell Hood, and during World War II served as a training center for tank destroyers. It is well-known for its military training for ground troops, heavy artillery exercises and war games which have been viewed by a number of dignitaries and presidents over the years.

Within Fort Hood is Gray AAF, known as Robert Gray Field, where AF personnel are attached while at Fort Hood. Little is known about the activities at Gray AAF as it is not a major AFB and is not listed in either the *Air Force Officer's Guide* or the *Air Force Almanac*.

An Air Force Captain, while stationed at Fort Hood in 1972, told me that in the late 60's a pilot had to make a forced landing over this restricted air corridor and as his small private plane came in for a landing on a dusty field, the next thing he saw was an approaching jeep with armed MPs which seemed to have appeared out of nowhere. On further observation by the pilot, he saw a huge section of land separating like "giant sliding doors" with vegetation intact revealing a huge corridor inside.

The startled pilot was then met with weapons trained on him and ordered out of the plane where he was immediately blindfolded and taken in the jeep to what he thought was this underground complex. He was taken down a long corridor and led into a room where his blindfold was taken off. Inside the room, which reminded him of a modern conference room without windows, he was interrogated by a couple of men and a few hours later was blindfolded again and taken outside to his aircraft which had been refueled and was now operating. He was warned not to speak of this incident as they helped him into the aircraft and watched him take off.

In the latter part of 1973, the entire Southeastern section of the U.S. was undergoing a wave of UFO sightings. The Central Texas area had an unusually large number of reports coming out of the farming communities around Calvert, Bremond, Temple and a few other small towns which is West and Southwest of Fort Hood.

On November 21, 1973, Gracia Unger, editor of the *Calvert Tribune* and her husband Jack, along with my wife and I, witnessed two UFOs near the Brazos River area during the height of the activity. The UFOs were shaped like "a brick with the ends wore off" and had a series of multi-colored, blinking lights on its surface.

The metallic structure of one of the craft was readily visible by the intense silver-blue white glow that surrounded the craft as it approached us at a low altitude. The body of the craft appeared to be made of an aluminum type metal construction. It was definitely a manufactured aircraft of some type and not just a ball-of-light in the night sky.

The two UFOs were first noticed coming out of the Northwest at a high altitude, one appeared at a slightly lower altitude than the other. As they neared the Brazos River, we became aware of the sound of helicopters approaching also out of the Northwest. At first, we thought these things may be helicopters until they got closer and then we saw the navigational lights on the helicopters headed toward these UFOs. There were seven helicopters in a line formation moving swiftly toward our location.

The UFOs were moving very slow and would stop for short periods of time, one at a considerably low altitude than the other. As the helicopters approached, we noticed that they were large Chinooks which took up a tight formation around and over these UFOs. Also, two jet interceptors entered the area from the Southwest and circled over the UFOs and helicopters as they proceeded South. The UFOs and helicopters disappeared out of our line-of-sight behind a clump of trees several miles in the distance. It appeared the UFOs may have landed, but since there were no backroads leading to this area, we do not know. The jets continued circling and then finally headed Southwest.

The next day, Gracia called Fort Hood and they told her that "there had been a routine reconnaissance training mission in progress that night, but they denied any knowledge of "flying saucers" being in the area.

A more in-depth discussion of these events and others around the Calvert, Texas area was published in the Spring 1975, Vol 2, No. 3 issue of *Saga UFO Report*.

It is interesting to note the similarities in this incident and that of the Cash/Landrum incident of Dec. 29, 1980 in which a low level UFO was being "escorted" by a number of helicopters, some Chinooks and possibly Hueys, near Dayton, Texas. A check with surrounding military installations revealed that Gray AAF/Fort Hood admitted that sometime during that period "more than 100 helicopters came in from the field 'for effect'." A detailed account of this incident was published in the Winter 1981, Vol. 9, No. 4 issue of *Saga UFO Report*.

In the Winter of 1974, while giving a talk show on UFOs in the Central Texas area, I was told by the News Director of the television station after the show that while filming over at Fort Hood he found out about the underground installation and that they were still conducting UFO research even though "Project Bluebook" had been terminated. He told me that the men that flew the helicopters were code-named "BLUEBOYS." He said there was a "special group" involved in this UFO project.

In 1975, while investigating the crashed disc stories, I came across a Lt. Col. in the Air Force, who was stationed at Carswell AFB near Fort Worth, that informed me about the UFO project at Fort Hood as well as a number of other military installations here in the States and overseas. (See Case B-4, this report)

In 1976, I met an individual in McGregor, Texas who told me that his father worked in the secret underground complex. He told me not to breathe a word of this to the public since his father's career could be seriously jeopardized and the fact that he was not even suppose to know what his father was involved in on the base. He stated that "the technology that is being applied in this underground complex would remind someone of a science-fiction thriller. It is unbelievable what they know and can do from this area."

During the Spring of 1975, I had been notified by some people in the Groesbeck-Mexia area that a UFO had been observed coming out of the South headed North and appeared to have crashed in the heavily-wood farm land area near Mexia. I immediately dispatched an investigative team to the area that night and talked with these people and the police department hoping to get some trajectory on the object.

While talking with the Captain of the Mexia Fire Department, I found out that the Texas Department of Public Safety had notified Fort Hood/Gray AAF about the incident and they were sending a squadron of helicopters to the area to search for the crashed object.

I realized my efforts would be futile since "they" would be well-equipped with infrared surveillance instruments and other sophisticated electronic instrumentation from the air. We searched desperately to find the spot from the ground before the helicopters arrived, but our efforts proved fruitless. We observed the helicopters as they approached the area that night, but they were apparently on a heading that took them a number of miles above where we had been searching in the Mexia area.

Later, I found out that the Texas Department of Public Safety works closely with Fort Hood/Gray AAF in matters such as this, which came as a surprise to me.

On Dec. 4, 1981, I gave a two-hour radio talk show on the Ed Busch program at KAAM radio station, Dallas, Texas called "America Overnight" via satellite. About halfway through the program, we had a caller from Ohio that told us in the Summer of 1975, he was stationed at Fort Hood with an aviation unit, RS-2 Intelligence, as a helicopter pilot and that one night around 10:00 p.m. he was driving with a friend on a highway near Fort Hood when they both saw a UFO accompanied by "Army helicopters."

He said, "I spent a lot of time flying helicopters and I know what one looks like at night, and if it's not. And the large object that we saw...there is no way it could have been a helicopter! It was an oblong, disc-type thing with a reddish light. The next day when I got back to base, I asked my friend that worked in the air traffic control out of the airfield if anything had happened. They didn't know anything. And I was a good friend to quite a few pilots so I asked them. No one knew anything. I thought this was unusually strange, because if something had happened you would usually get it through the grapevine."

12

He later found out that if he kept asking questions about what he had seen, he might not have his job anymore at the base. This was impressed upon his mind by some of his pilot friends, so he dropped the matter.

I have also found of interest the statistics of the frequency of object, unit, and all sightings within the United States from 1947 to 1952, by subdivisions of one degree of latitude and longitude as listed on page 47 of "FLYING SAUCERS: ANALYSIS OF THE AIR FORCE PROJECT BLUEBOOK SPECIAL REPORT NO. 14" prepared by Dr. Leon Davidson.

It appears that the highest number of UFO sightings occurred in four major areas of the United States, those being: Los Alamos Scientific Labs, N.M., Wright-Patterson AFB, Dayton, Ohio, the Washington, D.C. area and Gray AAF/Fort Hood in Central Texas. Three of these areas are well-known for being "sensitive" key military installations concerned with the national defense of the United States, but the fourth, Gray AAF/Fort Hood, is not so well-known for its activities in defense matters other than those I discussed in the beginning of this report. The implication of these statistics is not presently known, but it is interesting to see that Gray AAF/Fort Hood once again enters into the picture.

There have been a number of interesting UFO cases that have taken place in and around Los Alamos Scientific Laboratories, N.M. and Gray AAF/Fort Hood, Tx. and between these two areas. Some of these cases such as the Socorro, N.M. incident and the Eddie Laxton incident near Sheppard AFB, Wichita Falls, TX. and others seem to imply experimental testing of a new type of aircraft.